

THE SATAVAHANAS AND THE DECCAN

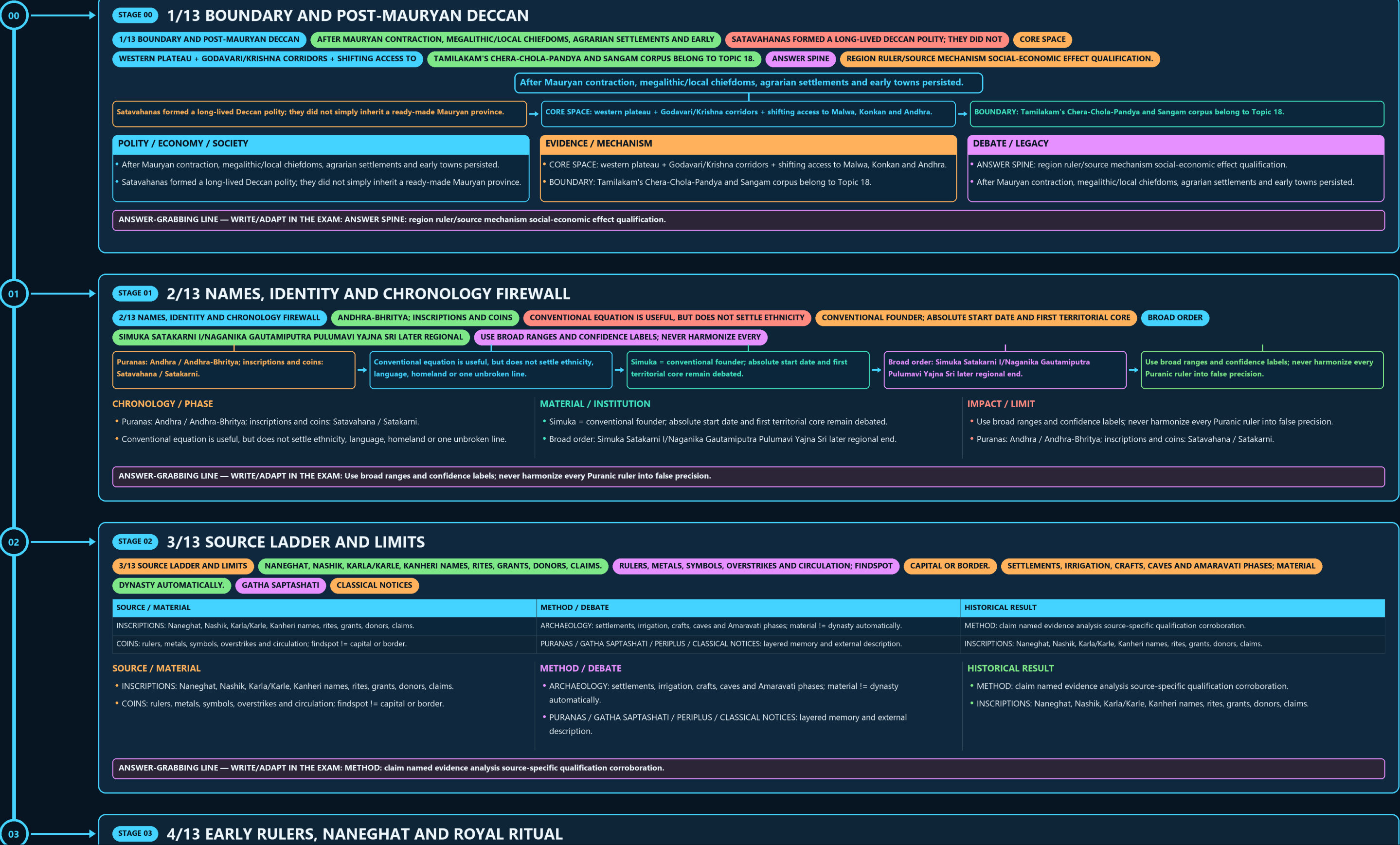
1/13 BOUNDARY AND POST-MAURYAN → 2/13 NAMES, IDENTITY AND → 3/13 SOURCE LADDER AND → 4/13 EARLY RULERS, NANEGHAT → 5/13 GAUTAMIPUTRA, NAHAPANA AND → 6/13 PULUMAVI, RUHRADAMAN AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

STAGE 03

4/13 EARLY RULERS, NANEGHAT AND ROYAL RITUAL

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SIMUKA OPENS THE CONVENTIONAL SEQUENCE; KANHA/KRISHNA IS LINKED WITH

SATAKARNI I + NAGANIKA

NANEGHAT GENEALOGY, PORTRAITS, TITLES, SACRIFICES AND MAJOR DAKSHINA.

PASS JOINS PLATEAU AND KONKAN

POLITICAL DISPLAY WAS PLACED ON A ROUTE OF MOVEMENT

QUEEN'S PUBLIC AGENCY IS SECURE; MATRIARCHY OR FEMALE-LINE SUCCESSION

REPEATED SATAKARNI NAMES REQUIRE INSCRIPTION-SPECIFIC IDENTIFICATION.

Simuka opens the conventional sequence; Kanha/Krishna is linked with early Nashik activity.

Satakarni I + Naganika: Naneghat genealogy, portraits, titles, sacrifices and major dakshina.

Pass joins plateau and Konkan: political display was placed on a route of movement and

Queen's public agency is secure; matriarchy or female-line succession is not.

Repeated Satakarni names require inscription-specific identification.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Queen's public agency is secure; matriarchy or female-line succession is not.

04

STAGE 04

5/13 GAUTAMIPUTRA, NAHAPANA AND JOGALTHEMBI

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NAHAPANA/KSHAHARATA POWER HELD WESTERN ROUTES, CAVES AND COASTAL CONNECTIONS.

GAUTAMI BALASHRI'S NASHIK PRASHASTI PRAISES GAUTAMIPUTRA AS KSHAHARATA DESTROYER

JOGALTHEMBI HOARD

NAHAPANA SILVER COINS OVERSTRUCK WITH GAUTAMIPUTRA DEVICES AND LEGENDS.

STRONG INFERENCE

TAKEOVER + CURRENCY REVALIDATION/REUSE; GRANT CONTEXT ADDS FISCAL DISPLACEMENT.

NO EXACT BATTLE DATE, TOTAL EXTERMINATION, PERMANENT FRONTIER OR

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT: no exact battle date, total extermination, permanent frontier or all-reign map.

05

STAGE 05

6/13 PULUMAVI, RUDRADAMAN AND SHIFTING GEOGRAPHY

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VASHISHTHIPUTRA PULUMAVI

NASHIK CONTEXT PLUS STRONG EASTERN DECCAN COIN/INSCRIPTION PRESENCE.

RUDRADAMAN'S JUNAGADH PRASHASTI CLAIMS TWO VICTORIES OVER A SATAKARNI

RIVALRY + MARRIAGE DIPLOMACY COEXISTED; NEITHER PRASHASTI IS A

MAJOR WESTERN CENTRE; AMARAVATI-DHARANIKOTA

MAJOR EASTERN ZONE.

CAPITAL, MINT, RELIGIOUS CENTRE AND INSCRIPTION FINDSPOT MUST NOT

Rudradaman's Junagadh prashasti claims two victories over a Satakarni spared because of kinship.

Rivalry + marriage diplomacy coexisted; neither prashasti is a neutral campaign report.

Pratishthana/Paithan = major western centre; Amaravati-Dharanikota = major eastern zone.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Rudradaman's Junagadh prashasti claims two victories over a Satakarni spared because of kinship.

THE SATAVAHANAS AND THE DECCAN • TILE 2/5 • same master rows 2324-5558 of 12529 • continues below

05

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DEBATE / LEGACY

- Capital, mint, religious centre and inscription findspot must not be collapsed into one category.
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MECHANISM / VERDICT — Rudradaman's Junagadh prashasti claims two victories over a Satakarni spared because of kinship.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Capital, mint, religious centre and inscription findspot must not be collapsed into one category.

06

STAGE 06 7/13 ADMINISTRATION AND LAYERED SOVEREIGNTY

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TERRITORIAL/REVENUE-ADMINISTRATIVE DIVISION; BOUNDARIES AND FUNCTIONS COULD VARY.

OFFICERS AND LOCAL INTERMEDIARIES.

POWERFUL REGIONAL CHIEFS, DONORS AND MARRIAGE PARTNERS.

COURT + OFFICERS + CHIEFS + VILLAGES + GUILDS

NETWORK POLITY.

"FEUDATORY" IS CAUTIOUS SHORTHAND; EVIDENCE DOES NOT PROVE A

AHARA = territorial/revenue-administrative division; boundaries and functions could vary.

AMATYA / MAHAMATRA / MAHASENAPATI / GRAMIKA = officers and local intermediaries.

MAHARATHI / MAHABHOJA = powerful regional chiefs, donors and marriage partners.

Court + officers + chiefs + villages + guilds + religious institutions = network polity.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- MAHARATHI / MAHABHOJA = powerful regional chiefs, donors and marriage partners.
- Court + officers + chiefs + villages + guilds + religious institutions = network polity.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- "Feudatory" is cautious shorthand; evidence does not prove a fixed mature feudal constitution.
- AHARA = territorial/revenue-administrative division; boundaries and functions could vary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: "Feudatory" is cautious shorthand; evidence does not prove a fixed mature feudal constitution.

07

STAGE 07 8/13 AGRARIAN CHANGE, GRANTS AND RURAL SETTLEMENT

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IRON TOOLS + PADDY TRANSPLANTATION IN SUITABLE ZONES +

KRISHNA-GODAVARI WET-RICE POTENTIAL CANNOT BE PROJECTED OVER THE ENTIRE

GRANTS AND FISCAL IMMUNITIES TRANSFER REVENUE/ACCESS RIGHTS TO BRAHMANAS

EARLY GRANTS ILLUMINATE INSTITUTIONAL CHANGE; THEY DO NOT AUTOMATICALLY

RURAL SURPLUS SUPPORTED COURTS, TOWNS, CRAFTS AND DONATIONS, BUT

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Iron tools + paddy transplantation in suitable zones + cotton + wells/tanks uneven intensification.
- Krishna-Godavari wet-rice potential cannot be projected over the entire plateau.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Grants and fiscal immunities transfer revenue/access rights to Brahmanas or religious establishments.
- Early grants illuminate institutional change; they do not automatically equal mature feudalism.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Rural surplus supported courts, towns, crafts and donations, but prosperity was socially uneven.
- Iron tools + paddy transplantation in suitable zones + cotton + wells/tanks uneven intensification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rural surplus supported courts, towns, crafts and donations, but prosperity was socially uneven.

08

STAGE 08 9/13 CRAFTS, SHRENIS, TOWNS AND TRADE ROUTES

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IRONWORKING, BEADS, POTTERY AND TEXTILES APPEAR AT DECCAN SETTLEMENT

OCCUPATIONAL ORGANIZATION, IDENTITY AND FINANCIAL ENDOWMENT; NOT A MODERN

PRATISHTHANA + TAGARA LINKED THROUGH PASSES TO KALYANA, SOPARA

EASTERN CORRIDORS JOINED INLAND CENTRES TO KRISHNA-GODAVARI AND AMARAVATI-DHARANIKOTA.

ROUTES SHOW CONNECTIVITY, NOT CONTINUOUS SATAVAHANA OWNERSHIP OF EVERY

Ironworking, beads, pottery and textiles appear at Deccan settlement and workshop sites.

SHRENI: occupational organization, identity and financial endowment; not a modern corporation.

Pratishthana + Tagara linked through passes to Kalyana, Sopara and Bharukachchha under shifting control.

Eastern corridors joined inland centres to Krishna-Godavari and Amaravati-Dharanikota.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Ironworking, beads, pottery and textiles appear at Deccan settlement and workshop sites.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Pratishthana + Tagara linked through passes to Kalyana, Sopara and Bharukachchha under shifting control.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Routes show connectivity, not continuous Satavahana ownership of every port and segment.

- Rural surplus supported courts, towns, crafts and donations, but prosperity was socially uneven.
- Iron tools + paddy transplantation in suitable zones + cotton + wells/tanks uneven intensification.

Varna-restoration claims = royal Brahmanical ideology, not a demographic census.

Matronymics = maternal gotra/lineage legitimacy within largely patrilineal succession; no matriarchy.

→

Merchants, artisans, Yavanas, women, monks/nuns and chiefs appear in donor inscriptions.

→

Prakrit in Brahmi dominates; Gatha Saptashati/Gaha Sattasai is attributed to Hala but layered.

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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- Prakrit in Brahmi dominates; Gatha Saptashati/Gaha Sattasai is attributed to Hala but layered.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Vedic sacrifice + Brahmanical identity coexisted with Buddhist cave/stupa patronage.
- Varna-restoration claims = royal Brahmanical ideology, not a demographic census.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vedic sacrifice + Brahmanical identity coexisted with Buddhist cave/stupa patronage.

11

STAGE 11

12/13 SITES, DONOR NETWORKS, ART AND CONTINUITY

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RIVAL KSHATRAPA/SATAVAHANA RECORDS, GRANTS, CAVES AND GAUTAMI BALASHRI'S PRASHASTI.

KARLA/KARLE + KANHERI

ROUTE-LINKED, MULTI-DONOR CHAITYA-VIHARA NETWORKS; PATRONAGE

EXCLUSIVE CREED.

LOWER KRISHNA MAHACHAITYA, LONG MULTI-PHASE SEQUENCE CROSSING DYNASTIC BOUNDARIES.

ART CROSS-LINK

USE AMARAVATI FORM AND CIRCULATION, BUT ROUTE DETAILED STYLE

Nashik: rival Kshatrapa/Satavahana records, grants, caves and Gautami Balashri's prashasti.

Karla/Karle + Kanheri: route-linked, multi-donor chaitya-vihara networks; patronage != exclusive creed.

→

Amaravati: lower Krishna mahachaitya, long multi-phase sequence crossing dynastic boundaries.

→

Art cross-link: use Amaravati form and circulation, but route detailed style history to Art &

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Nashik: rival Kshatrapa/Satavahana records, grants, caves and Gautami Balashri's prashasti.
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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Amaravati: lower Krishna mahachaitya, long multi-phase sequence crossing dynastic boundaries.
- Art cross-link: use Amaravati form and circulation, but route detailed style history to Art & Culture.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Decline produced Ikshvaku, Abhira, Chutu and other regional formations with institutional continuity.
- Nashik: rival Kshatrapa/Satavahana records, grants, caves and Gautami Balashri's prashasti.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Decline produced Ikshvaku, Abhira, Chutu and other regional formations with institutional continuity.

12

STAGE 12

13/13 UPSC TRAPS AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

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ETHNICITY PROOF; COIN

BORDER; PRASHASTI

NEUTRAL REPORT; DONOR

POPULATION CENSUS.

SATAKARNI I—NAGANIKA—NANEGHAT

GAUTAMIPUTRA—BALASHRI—NASHIK—NAHAPANA OVERSTRIKES.

PULUMAVI—EASTERN PHASE

TRAPS: Andhra != ethnicity proof; coin != border; prashasti != neutral report; donor != population

MATCH: Satakarni I—Naganika—Naneghat

Gautamiputra—Balashri—Nashik—Nahapana overstrikes.

MATCH: Pulumavi—eastern phase

Rudradaman—Junagadh rival claim

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- TRAPS: Andhra != ethnicity proof; coin != border; prashasti != neutral report; donor != population census.
- MATCH: Satakarni I—Naganika—Naneghat
- Gautamiputra—Balashri—Nashik—Nahapana overstrikes.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- MATCH: Pulumavi—eastern phase
- Rudradaman—Junagadh rival claim
- Vajna Sri—ship motif.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- PARAGRAPH: claim named inscription/coin/site/text analysis qualification.
- VERDICT: Satavahana power integrated a diverse Deccan through layered rule, production, routes and plural patronage without uniform control or timeless prosperity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Satavahana power integrated a diverse Deccan through layered rule, production, routes and plural patronage without uniform control or timeless prosperity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Satavahana power integrated a diverse Deccan through layered rule, production, routes and plural patronage without uniform control or timeless prosperity.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE SATAVAHANAS & THE DECCAN — ADVANCED

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- The Satavahanas & the Deccan — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept — Prashasti as source
- The Nashik inscription of Gautami Balashri eulogizes Gautamiputra as restorer of Satavahana glory and terminator of the Kshaharatas.
- Gautamiputra's coins occur in the eastern Deccan too, showing that Satavahana power was not confined to one western zone.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.